

TURNING TRAGEDY INTO TRIUMPH

TEXT: JOHN 10:10 (NKJV) *“The thief does not come except to steal, and to kill, and to destroy. I have come that they may have life, and that they may have it more abundantly.”*

INTRO: When tragedy strikes people either run to God or from God. Some people tend to get mad at God when something bad happens. John 10:10 is very clear, anything that falls under the heading of stealing, killing or destroying is NOT from God, but the responsible party is the devil!

Let me state it emphatically, not only is God the one who sends blessing; what the devil meant for evil God will turn it around and use it for your temporal and eternal good. Turnaround in your life is what God is trying to accomplish!

If we will trust God and follow Him there are four things He will accomplish in us and through us, even though we are facing the biggest test of our lives.

GOD WILL HELP US

Psalm 9:7-11 (NKJV) “***The LORD reigns forever, executing judgment from his throne. 8 He will judge the world with justice and rule the nations with fairness. 9 The LORD is a shelter for the oppressed, a refuge in times of trouble. 10 Those who know your name trust in you, for you, O LORD, have never abandoned anyone who searches for you. 11 Sing praises to the LORD who reigns in Jerusalem. Tell the world about his unforgettable deeds.***”

You are still alive... You survived the storm... Everything else can be replaced... God will send help in many forms... He will send help through FEMA... Your insurance company... Your friends and family... Your

church... **(PLAY BLAKE MAULDINS VIDEO)**

YOU CAN HELP YOURSELF

Psalm 144:1 (NKJV) ***“Blessed be the Lord my Rock, Who trains my hands for war, And my fingers to fight.”***

(Guy who was stranded & praying for God to rescue him – A canoe, a boat & a helicopter came by and offered help but he refused saying *“God is going to rescue me.”* He drowned and when he got to Heaven he was complaining to Saint Peter that God did not show up, Saint Peter said, *“We sent a canoe, a boat and a helicopter.”*

Do what you can to help yourself... Digging ditches n my back yard (Have hammer)... God helps those who help themselves... God will lead u into a Holy setup but some assembly may be required...

OTHERS CAN HELP YOU

Discuss all the ways we have received help... Don't be too prideful to accept help when you need it (*“Pride goes before destruction... God hates pride...”*)

Volunteers local and non local... BBQ... First Baptist Queen City... Doug Stringer, somebody Cares helped provide the gift cards – (Pass out gift cards to those who need them)

(Manager at Macy's & mall) - Drivers from Chicago) - You may be a giver but if u cannot be a gracious receiver the process of giving cannot be completed & u will never be able to give as much as you dream of giving...

YOU CAN HELP OTHERS

People whose homes were damaged, here helping others... **(FAUSTINO AND AMY VIDEO)** Recognize all our volunteers and

pray for them... Pray for all people affected
by this storm...